Security: Stability as strategy

African insecurity is defined by complex threats, from insurgencies and political instability to unequal access to food and water, which, as data from the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance (IIAG) shows, mirror weak governance and deep structural vulnerability.

However, while the space and resources to address this insecurity have narrowed, it has become more important than ever to acknowledge that African insecurity has global consequences. From migration pressures to disrupted supply chains, these dynamics increasingly threaten the long-term stability of the Global North.

While BRICS and the G20 are not security alliances, South Africa has the prerogative to use these groupings as a platform to argue this case and frame Africa's long-term security as a global risk vector.

As Signal Risk's Ronak Gopaldas argues, this also means asserting Africa's "value proposition" more aggressively. Africa is increasingly the most demographically significant continent, with the world's youngest population and one in four people on earth estimated to be African by 2050.

As such, if security conditions that enable technological development, economic advancement, political stability and human safety are not improved, the consequences thereof will be global crises.

Using multilateralism to champion investment in Africa's security is both an approach to development and global risk mitigation. South Africa will be a defining voice in the next era of global governance and multilateralism to come.



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